

SKOAR!

# DARK SOULS

## Prepare to die

A glutton for punishment

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**D**ark Souls is one of the hardest games we've played in a long time. You need to be prepared to die and die again and again and again and again and you'll still revel in it. It isn't that this game has some sort of murderously intelligent AI or that it has an artificially jacked up difficulty level, the enemies re-spawn after every checkpoint (bonfires) and each enemy will always follow its own, but consistent, attack pattern. In any other game, these very same issues would be something we would complain about but not so in Dark Souls. When it comes to combat, you have everything that you need, you know where the enemies are, you know their attack patterns, you can even figure out what weapon would suit you best and despite all this, you'll still die a hundred times and every single time it will be your fault. You always know that you screwed up and you'll feel stupid for not being able to deal with it and you'll want to try and try again till you succeed.

The same goes for the boss fights, with the added exception that instead of one

fixed attack pattern, they might have 2 or 3 patterns depending on their health. Why the combat is so much fun is hard to really explain. Maybe it's because it never feels like the game is unfair, or that the mechanics are never at fault. It always is your fault that you screwed up and it is that urge to improve your game that pushes you forward, taking that punishment over and over again to get that little bit better. One misstep and you fall off a ledge. Why? You were in a hurry and forgot about it. You spend that last bit of stamina on just one more swing of your axe and then you realize you've got nothing left to dodge that massive club coming down on your head and you just know that it was your greed that got the better of you.

Punishment and reward, these are what make or break a game and Dark Souls somehow got it right. This game is no mindless, button-mashing frenzy; it requires thought and it requires patience and even more importantly, ceaseless vigilance. The game won't hold your hand in anyway, it forces you to grow up, to think for yourself; there are no objective markers, no journal to keep track of quests and no map to show you where to go. There is a story but it's not immediately apparent. The lowliest minion can make short work of you, if you're not careful and the biggest boss can be a cake walk

with the right tools. The game will throw challenge after challenge at you and you will face them and you will overcome them. \*

### Verdict

Dark Souls is not a game that will appeal to everyone. If you're used to having your hand held at every turn or just generally want to play a game to unwind, this is not for you. This is a game that demands your time and will stress your patience to its limits. With Dark Souls, From software has created one of the most compelling and atmospheric action RPGs ever and it is an experience that must not be missed.

Don't forget to check out our online review for a more detailed perspective.

### MOAR!

- » **Developer:** From software
- » **Publisher:** Namco Bandai
- » **Genre:** action RPG, open world
- » **Price:** PC: ₹2100 (steam)

